first for Tata Trusts in many ways. Thus, when the Trusts identified the need to educate and popularize the internet among women to enhance the possibilities of their employment, he chose to collaborate with Google. Tata Trusts are similarly working with the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation for preventing diarrhoea. In addition, they also adorned the mantle of an NGO, when the World Bank began providing funds to Tata Trusts to undertake projects.

Health, Technology and Universality

One of the areas that has received particular attention from Ratan as chairman of Tata Trusts is the health and wellness of people—a segment that can have a multiplier effect on the welfare of the family and society. To achieve this, he has embarked on hitherto-untrodden paths seeking assistance from the best organizations in the world that can help usher in the change. As in business, in philanthropy too his focus has been to harness technology for the benefit of the society.

Ratan believes that technology is central to transformation, especially in combating dangerous diseases. He has employed applicable technology to find better treatment for the poor for cancer, heart diseases and diabetes for instance. At the same time, he has emphasized that it need not necessarily be technology of the ‘space age or state-of-the-art’ category, but the kind of technology that would be accessible to the general public too. Among the many initiatives taken, Tata Trusts made a special endowment to Indian Institute of Science’s (IISc) Centre for Neuroscience in 2014 to study the cause of Alzheimer’s disease.

Within the health sector, tackling malnutrition is an area that has been Ratan’s focus since his retirement as chairman, Tata Sons. Speaking in Paris in 2015, three years after demitting office, he expressed anguish at the extent of malnutrition in India and how it was impacting mainly mothers and children. He identified the disproportionate loss of infants and the physical and mental disabilities they have on account of malnutrition and declared his intention to intervene, stating that ‘this was an area that one could make a difference’.

He added that the problem is a ‘much bigger issue’ as it has linkages to ‘sanitation and health’, requiring a holistic approach. He stated his resolve